

Attack or Fault in Real Incidents: A Structured Case Study of Cause Ambiguity at Trading Infrastructure

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Abstract

[Abstract to be drafted once the case table exists.]

Keywords incident response; cause attribution; trading infrastructure; case study; cyberattack; system failure

1. Introduction

2. Background and related work

3. Research questions and the assumptions they examine

4. Method

4.1. Design and unit of analysis

4.2. Corpus and sources

4.3. Search and screening

4.4. Coding, agreement and reconciliation

4.5. Analysis

5. The cases

6. Cross-case results

6.1. RQ1: Was the cause ambiguous while operators acted?

6.2. RQ2: Did market-facing observables settle the cause?

6.3. RQ3: What did operators do while the cause was unknown?

6.4. RQ4: Is strategic imitation documented?

6.5. Where the evidence of ambiguity lives

6.6. Sensitivity and disconfirming cases

7. Discussion

8. Limitations and threats to validity

9. Conclusion

Data availability

[Data availability statement to be written.]

Funding

[To be supplied.]

Conflict of interest

[To be supplied.]

Use of AI tools

[To be supplied.]